Santhosh. In addition to his political responsibilities, Joshi has been involved in various social initiatives, including the mid-day meal project for school children in his home state

Twain shall meet Joshi has held crucial portfolios like Coal, Mines and Parliamentary Affairs in previous Modi regimes, but his new ministry comes with a unique issue—two separate ministers for power and renewable energy. Joshi will have to ensure that the two departments work in tandem

Minister of State

SHRIPAD YESSO NAIK, *71* | BJP

North Goa MP is also MoS, Power

import taxes and then went back on it within the space of a year

CAPACITY-BUILDING India is looking to build more than three times capacity of renewables by the end of 2030. But for this, the country has to instal at least 40 gigawatts a year to meet its goal of installing 500 GW of clean energy by the end of the decade. To keep things in perspective, India managed to add just 13.7 GW in renewable energy—solar, wind and water included—in 2023

GREEN HYDROGEN MISSION The National Green Hydrogen Mission, launched in 2023, is set on making India a major hub for the production and export of the resource. It plans to produce 5 MT of green hydrogen annually by 2030. The Centre has set aside Rs 19,750 crore for the mission

CONSUMER AFFAIRS, FOOD & PUBLIC DISTRIBUTION

Consumer Care

Managing buffer stocks and PDS disbursal are the challenge and the prize for the ministry

By AVISHEK G. DASTIDAR

The ministry fulfils its mandate to ensure food security to all through two mechanisms—the public distribution system as well as the various price support mechanisms, like procurement of foodgrains at minimum support prices. The consumer affairs department looks after protection of consumer rights in all spheres. And of late, it has been active in expanding its reach to consumer redressal in the online space. ■

PRALHAD JOSHI
Minister of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution

Minister of State



NIMUBEN J. BAMBHANIYA, *58* | BJP

Sterling win A former mayor of Bhavnagar Municipal Corporation. Won the Bhavnagar LS seat by over 400,000 votes



B.L. VERMA, *62* | BJP

Policy man A Rajya Sabha MP from UP, the RSS veteran was an LIC agent before joining politics

WHAT NEEDS TO BE DONE

Management of buffer stock
The silos are bursting at the seams. India is sitting on a rice stock that is four times the buffer target. And a new crop will be added in September. The country needs a smart solution that offers optimal use of stocks while ensuring the PDS system is not disrupted at any time

Price balance
The government needs to ensure a price balance in procurement of essential commodities that does not break the bank and is also to the satisfaction of both consumer and producer, something that has been a perpetual challenge

Consumer rights The ministry must ensure strict implementation of the Consumer Protection Act rules and act as a watchdog against unfair trade practices, especially in this e-commerce age. Also has to protect Indian MSMEs by imposing non-tariff barriers on foreign goods, including adherence to stringent BIS norms